

wireless charging, and on-ear detection round out the extensive feature set, making the OnePlus Buds Pro 3 one of the most feature-rich TWS earbuds on the market today.

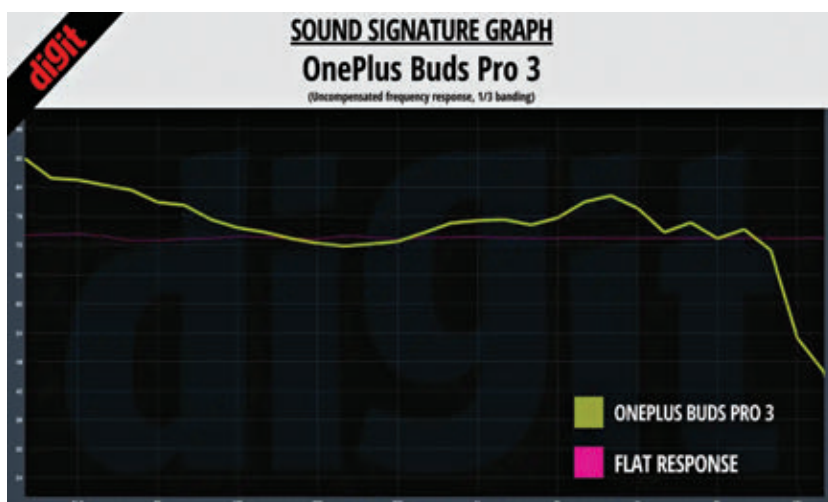
PERFORMANCE

The OnePlus Buds Pro 3 doesn't just boast a design overhaul; the internal hardware has seen a significant upgrade as well. Like its predecessor, the Buds Pro 3 is tuned by Dynaudio and features dual drivers—an 11mm woofer and a 6mm tweeter in each earbud. However, this time around, OnePlus has enhanced the drivers and added two Digital-to-Analog Converters (DACs) per earbud. This dual DAC setup allows for better instrument separation, as one DAC handles the tweeter while the other focuses on the woofer, resulting in a more balanced and dynamic audio experience.

The sound signature of the Buds Pro 3 leans towards a V-shape, with prominent lows and sparkly highs. The bass is full-bodied, delivering a punchy and energetic performance, while the highs remain clear and detailed. However, the mid-range—specifically the 250-500 Hz range—experiences a slight dip, leading to some auditory masking in the mids. This means that male vocals and instruments that fall within this range might sound a bit recessed, especially compared to competitors like the OPPO Enco X2, which offers a more refined mid-range performance.

Despite this minor shortcoming, the overall sound quality is impressive, especially for the price. The bass attack is strong, and the upper mids provide excellent clarity, making the Buds Pro 3 suitable for a wide range of music genres. The soundstage is decent for in-ear headphones but gets a noticeable boost with Spatial Audio enabled. Additionally, the imaging and instrument separation are top-notch, allowing for a detailed and immersive listening experience.

When it comes to call quality, the Buds Pro 3 is no slouch. Equipped with three microphones per earbud, along with a Bone Conducting Voice Pickup Sensor and an AI algorithm, these ear-



buds deliver clear and crisp call quality even in noisy environments. Whether you're in a bustling cafe or taking a call on the go, your voice comes through loud and clear, making it a great choice for those who need reliable call performance.

BATTERY LIFE

Battery life is another area where the OnePlus Buds Pro 3 shines. According to OnePlus, the earbuds can deliver up to 10 hours of playtime on a single charge with ANC turned off and AAC codec active. The charging case provides an additional 33 hours of battery life, bringing the total to an impressive 43 hours of playback time. With ANC enabled, the battery life drops to 6 hours for the earbuds and 25.5 hours total with the case.

In real-world testing, the Buds Pro 3 lived up to OnePlus' claims, delivering around 6.2 hours of playtime with ANC on and AAC active. Additionally, the earbuds support fast charging, which gives you 10 hours of playback time with just a 10-minute charge. Wireless charging is also available, which is quite convenient.

VERDICT

OnePlus has a potential hit on its hands with the OnePlus Buds Pro 3. The Buds Pro 3 offers a compelling package of stylish design, excellent sound quality, and a robust feature set and is well worth its price tag. The

faux leather texture adds a touch of class, and the redesigned case feels premium. Sonically, the Buds Pro 3 impress with their powerful bass, clear highs, and good instrument separation, though the mid-range could use a bit more refinement.

With effective ANC, extensive app-based customisations, and solid battery life, the Buds Pro 3 proves to be a strong contender in the TWS market. While there are minor quirks, such as the weight of the case and some distortion with Spatial Audio head-tracking, these don't detract from the overall experience too much. These buds easily secure the Digit seal of approval. So, if you're in the market for feature-packed earbuds with great sound, the OnePlus Buds Pro 3 should definitely be on your radar.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Driver Size: 11 mm + 6 mm | DAC: 2x BES2700ZP | Frequency Response: 10 Hz - 40 kHz | Microphone Sensitivity: -38 dBV/Pa | Microphones: 3 mics + VPU | Active Noise Cancellation: Up to 50 dB | Bluetooth Codecs: AAC, SBC, LHDC 5.0 | Bluetooth Version: 5.4 | IP Rating: IP55 | Battery Life (without ANC): 10 hours (earbuds), 43 hours (earbuds + case) | Battery Life (with ANC): 6 hours (earbuds), 25.5 hours (earbuds + case) | Charging: 10 mins for 5.5 hours (earbuds) | App: HeyMelody | Colours: Midnight Opus, Lunar Radiance

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